

Five Steps to Financial Wellbeing

is all but left out of the school curriculum in the UK, and where it is taught, it is often lacking in vital context or connection to other personal skills. For many, this results in a disconnect between money and the rest of our existence, which leaves us with a misunderstanding of the interplay between our wallets and our happiness. If there is a widely recognized connection between money and wellbeing, then it's simply whether we can afford a Peloton, say, or a far-flung holiday. This is, of course, part of it – but only a very small one. There is so much more to be explored and explained, from the impact of financial hardship on mental health to the damage that can be done by an unhealthy obsession with cash.

Even if you happen to be one of the lucky ones – someone whose parents have always taken an active interest in teaching you about money – there's no guarantee that you'll end up finding it easy, because the second that we are launched into the world of work and money, of earning and owning and owing, the whole playing field changes. We're faced with temptations and judgements, often simultaneously, that cloud our ability to make decisions and can quickly evaporate any confidence we might have had in our money-management skills, as well as any cash we might have. We are not warned early enough about how advertising will convince us that we're lacking something, in order to sell us yet another thing that we don't need. And it won't just happen once, but time and time again.